

Rs 250 cr

is the loss suffered by multiplexes at an average running cost of Rs 5 cr a month.

Rs 100 cr

is amount that film producers have lost in terms of interest costs.

Rs 240 cr

is the net box office revenue so far this year. It was Rs 335 cr in the first five months of 2008.

Bollywood's WORST SEASON

Falling star fees. Shelved projects. Negatives piled up in labs. Can the movie business have a happy ending?

By Kaveree Bamzai

The Eiffel Tower, lit blue for France's ascendancy to the European Union's presidency, glows as Salman Khan proposes to Asin in *London Dreams*. Deepika Padukone as a fresco artist works to restore Delhi's Purana Qila in *Love Aaj Kal*, as a dad dispenses romantic wisdom to his engineer son through his own flashback in a movie that spans from the Golden Gate in San Francisco to the Albert Bridge in London.

Sylvester Stallone lifts heavy objects and flings bad guys around on the Universal Studios lot in Los Angeles, with Akshay Kumar as his body double in *Kambakkht Ishq*. John Abraham plays an NRI Muslim and Neil Nitin Mukesh is a fresh-off-the-boat Muslim in post 9/11 America in Yash Raj Films' *New York*. And Kylie Minogue sashays at a cost of Rs 5 crore to A.R. Rahman's music as the sharks in the Bahamas compete with Lara Dutta's string bikinis in *Blue*.

Romance! Action! Deep sea thrills! Politics! Hollywood, all right, ageing Hollywood